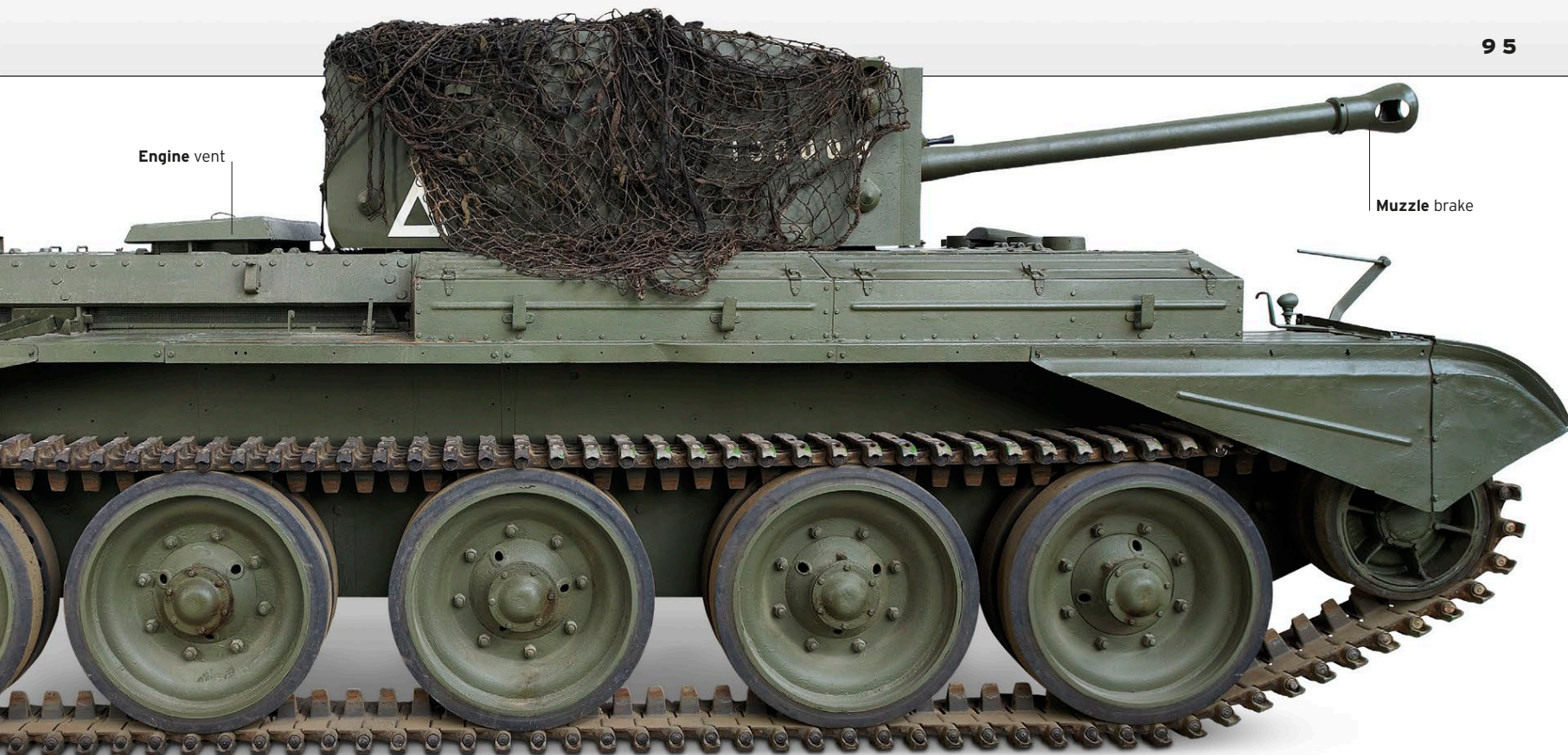




△ Cromwell IV

Date 1944 **Country** UK

Weight 30.8 tons (27.9 tonnes)

Engine Rolls-Royce Meteor Mark IB gasoline, 600 hp

Main armament QF 75 mm gun

A version of the Merlin aircraft power plant, the Cromwell's Meteor engine made it one of the fastest tanks of the war. This, and the tank's low height, made it popular with the Armored Reconnaissance Regiments in northwest Europe. However, it was outclassed by heavier German tanks. The Cromwell IV, shown here, was the most common variant produced.



△ Comet

Date 1944 **Country** UK

Weight 36.4 tons (33 tonnes)

Engine Rolls-Royce Meteor Mark III gasoline, 600 hp

Main armament QF 77 mm HV gun

Arguably the best British tank of the war, the Comet only reached the front lines in limited numbers in early 1945. It was more heavily armored but its stronger suspension gave it similar mobility to the lighter Cromwell. The 77 mm gun, which could fit in its smaller turret, was slightly less powerful than the 17-pounder.

▷ Sherman Firefly

Date 1944 **Country** UK

Weight 38.4 tons (34.9 tonnes)

Engine Chrysler A57 Multibank gasoline, 400 hp

Main armament QF 17-pounder gun

The British upgraded the Sherman with the 17-pounder gun. Fireflies never fully replaced 75 mm-armed Shermans, as the 17-pounder was less effective against non-armoured targets. It was a target for the Germans, so many crews camouflaged the long barrel. This is an M4A4 variant, with a longer hull due to its engine size.



△ Challenger A30

Date 1944 **Country** UK

Weight 35.3 tons (32 tonnes)

Engine Rolls-Royce Meteor gasoline, 600 hp

Main armament QF 17-pounder gun

The Challenger's 17-pounder gun was much more capable than previous British weapons, but also much larger. The tank's hull was based on the Cromwell, but lengthened to support the wider and taller turret. Just 200 Challengers were built, and they were used to provide long-range antitank support to units using Cromwells.